

The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — THURSDAY, OCTOBER 1, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:45 A.M.

YOUR DAY

Two GDG nights ahead; La Casa and Buildathon still off the calendar; Hetzner still open

Overnight mail stacked a Saturday GDG math-for-AI session on Friday's Maps + AI reminder; both approved October events and Hetzner's warning are still open. Tonight is the weekday skeleton—plus Motorama at the Auditorio if you want out.



Ferdinand, Checkpoint was last night. Today returns to News, Swim, Miami, Discovery, and Journaling at 10:00 p.m.—no second evening checklist until Wednesday.

Overnight mail stacked the week. GDG CDMX added Saturday's Probabilidad & Estadística Científica at 7:00 p.m. CST (Bayes, Pandas/SciPy); Friday's Maps Platform + AI at 7:00 p.m. is still mail-only. GitHub pinged twice before dawn—Modal OAuth added, Claude app wants updated permissions. Audiogram-inbox went quiet after Wednesday's red checks on #17/#18. Hetzner's Final Payment Warning from Sep 25 is still open. La Casa de Satoshi (Oct 6) and the Reap x AIBM Buildathon (Oct 9) remain approved in Luma and off Google Calendar.

TODAY

6:00–6:30	News / catchup	RECURRING
6:30–8:30	Swim	RECURRING
10:15 / 3:00	Food	RECURRING
4:00–6:30	Miami	RECURRING
6:30–10:00	Discovery Flex if Motorama	RECURRING
10:00–11:00	Journaling	RECURRING

THIS WEEK

THU OCT 1 – Weekday skeleton; News / Swim / Miami / Discovery / Journaling.
FRI OCT 2 – GDG CDMX: Maps Platform + AI, 7:00 p.m. CST; AI Studio + Maps + Gemini + Cloud Run.
SAT OCT 3 – GDG CDMX: Probabilidad & Estadística Científica, 7:00 p.m. CST; Bayes + EDA; not on calendar.
TUE OCT 6 – ¿La IA nos matará a todos? 6–9 p.m.; La Casa de Satoshi; approved (not on calendar).
WED OCT 7 – Checkpoint day 10:00 p.m.–midnight; overlaps Journaling.
FRI OCT 9 – Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon, 5–9 p.m.; Sandbox Hub CDMX; approved.

TONIGHT

Discovery into Journaling at 10:00 p.m.; Motorama at Auditorio Nacional 9:00 p.m. if you leave the skeleton. Light evening shower risk.

DUE

Hetzner final warning / services blocked (still open).

WEATHER

~24° / ~15° HIGH / LOW

Cool and damp at compile (~15°C with light rain nearby). The middle of the day stays overcast and climbs into the low-to-mid 20s. Light showers are likelier again toward evening. A light layer covers Miami into Discovery.

FRI	Overcast / patchy rain; shower odds rise into evening	~23 / ~15
SAT	Cooler morning; overcast; lighter evening shower risk	~22 / ~12
SUN	Continued cooler shower pattern	~21 / ~14

NEEDS A LOOK

GDG CDMX	FYI
Sat Probabilidad 7 p.m. + Fri Maps+AI 7 p.m. – both mail-only, not on calendar.	
GITHUB	ACTION
Modal OAuth added; Claude app wants more access – confirm if expected.	
HETZNER BILLING	ACTION
Final warning still open (Fri Sep 25); no payment-received mail.	
LUMA / LA CASA	ACTION
AI-risk talk Tue Oct 6, 6–9 p.m. – approved, still off calendar.	
AUDIOGRAM / BUILDATHON	FYI
Audiogram quiet after Wed #17/#18 red; Buildathon Fri Oct 9 approved (Sandbox Hub).	

INBOX

TLDR

Gemini 4, Apple smart home, Workspace Comments API

FROM TLDR

Google's Gemini 4 Argon leads internal benchmarks but isn't public yet; Apple lines up a smart-home hub for mid-October; Docs/Sheets/Slides APIs can finally manage comments in code.

GOOGLE ANNOUNCES GEMINI 4 ARGON AI MODEL, BUT YOU CAN'T USE IT YET

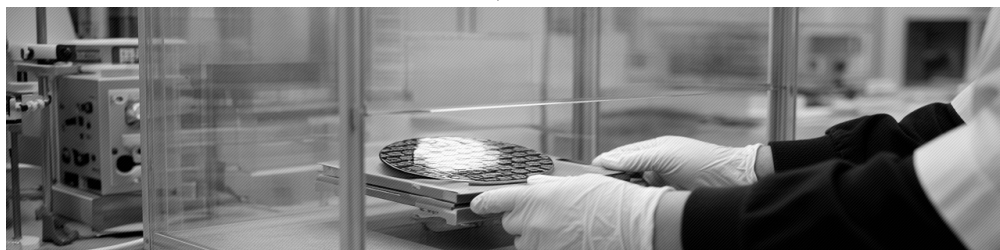
Google's Gemini 4 Argon model offers industry-leading performance in coding, knowledge work, and cybersecurity. Google's engineers are already using the model extensively, and Argon-powered agents have been working to migrate C/C++ codebases to Rust across Google. The model supports an output limit of 1 million tokens. Pricing for a limited-time window was listed in the newsletter (amounts omitted here). The model is still in limited testing, and there is no timeline for when it will be available to enterprise and consumer customers.

APPLE IS FINALLY READY TO ENTER ITS NEXT BIG CATEGORY: THE SMART HOME

Apple is preparing to launch several smart home devices on October 13. The company plans to ship a smart-home hub, an updated HomePod mini, and a new TV set-top box. The company is developing a broader smart-home ecosystem that expands on HomeKit software and supports new categories of connected products. It is also working with third-party manufacturers on devices designed for the Siri AI home platform.

PROGRAMMATIC COMMENT AND SUGGESTION SUPPORT NOW AVAILABLE IN THE GOOGLE DOCS, SHEETS, AND SLIDES APIS

Developers can now programmatically create, read, and manage comments across Google Docs, Sheets, and Slides. The Google Docs API also supports suggested edits. Organizations can now connect internal review tools, automated content pipelines, and project tracking systems directly into Google Workspace editors.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: TLDR also flags DeepMind watermarking AI-designed proteins, a commit-description habit for reviewing agent diffs, and Reddit killing RSS and public API access on November 13 over bot scraping. Quick links include DoorDash's text-to-order food agent and a short note on connecting agents with cryptography. A second TLDR-family issue the same morning covers Opus 5.5 "Claudisms," Parquet inspection, and DuckDB 1.5.6—clip is the Gemini 4 flagship.

BYTEBYTEGO

How DoorDash Built a Toolbox for AI Agents

FROM BYTEBYTEGO

MCP alone wasn't enough at DoorDash scale—so engineering built a shared Agent Gateway for permissions, credentials, curated tool catalogs, and audit trails.

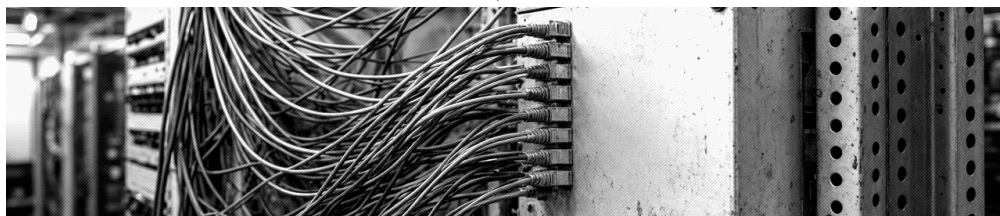
The utility of AI agents increases when they can take real actions in real systems. This involves the use of tools. While MCP made it easier to expose these tools, there were a lot of other concerns that had to be handled in order to make it work at an enterprise level.

DoorDash built a shared Agent Gateway to control how AI agents discover and use tools. The gateway brings together several responsibilities: checking permissions, managing credentials, choosing which tools an agent can see, forwarding requests, and recording what happened.

In this article, we will look at how the DoorDash engineering team built this gateway and the decisions they made.

A language model can write a super-detailed explanation of how to investigate a software problem, but it doesn't automatically have access to a company's code repositories, incident reports, or production logs. We need to provide access to those systems through software. From the perspective of the model, these systems are like tools.

An AI agent is an application that uses a language model to decide which steps and tools to use while working on a particular task. A tool is a specific capability that the application makes available to the model. For example, searching documentation, reading a support ticket, and opening a pull request.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: ByteByteGo splits the problem into access, tool-surface curation, and operations, then walks the proxy-plus-registry design: authenticate the caller, inject credentials without handing keys to the agent, pause for OAuth when needed, fan out discovery across bundles, and re-check policy on every tools/call. DoorDash reports 200-plus registered MCP servers, 30-plus agents, and millions of tool calls a week. Next on their list: stronger agent identity with short-lived delegated credentials, and dynamic catalogs narrowed to the current task.

INBOX

EVERY

How Sam Altman Uses Dots to Take Back His Time

BY LAURA ENTIS

On the first Every Podcast episode (the old AI & I show, renamed), Altman walks Dan Shipper through Dotty, Ultrafast-only prompting, and a Renaissance bet for AI.

This week, Dan sits down with Sam Altman at OpenAI’s annual DevDay, where the company shipped twenty-two products and features, more than twice as many as last year. (Altman: “Just wait for next year.”)

His Dot (named “Dotty” for now) gave Altman his mornings back—triaging fires so he only hears what’s urgent. “I get this space for creativity or to just hang out with my kids,” he says.

Altman’s Dot also lets him build again: he leaves Dotty notes about a feature and it ships a handful of versions to review. He only prompts on Ultrafast because the faster loop changes how he thinks.

EDITOR’S SUMMARY: Altman expects a paid frontier of speed/intelligence to keep existing and hopes AI expands human potential more like a Renaissance than an Industrial Revolution. Shipper compares his own Dot (“Boo”); Natalia Quintero joins as co-host later this month. Links/transcript in the Every mail.



THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

Distributed databases with Peter Mattis

FROM THE PRAGMATIC ENGINEER

Cockroach Labs’ CTO on GIMP, Gmail B-trees, Colossus, Raft, and why agents pulled him back into writing code without dropping the quality bar.

Peter Mattis—Cockroach Labs CTO, GIMP co-creator, and a veteran of Gmail and Google storage—ships more database-grade code with AI today without dropping the quality bar he held when he wrote ~100K lines a year by hand.

He traces the path from open source to Google to CockroachDB, and how AI pulled him back into writing code after years of management. Takeaway: he almost didn’t ship GIMP after hearing about a rival—“There’s always going to be someone else working on your idea.”

EDITOR’S SUMMARY: Mattis covers B-trees→Colossus→CockroachDB ranges, three-replica Raft defaults, and Pebble replacing RocksDB. On AI: expect teams to stop reading agent output the way they stopped reading assembly; non-engineers at Cockroach built ~1,000 internal apps in months. Episode + transcript on the PE page.

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

Animals – Netflix, Oct 9

Ben Affleck told Bloomberg’s Screentime audience that he used AI “for lots of things” on the Netflix thriller Animals—and won’t spoil which shots. Kerry Washington, Gillian Anderson, and Steven Yeun co-star. Streams October 9 for the tech-and-film angle without a theater run.

Queen Budapest – in cinemas from Oct 7

The 1986 Budapest stadium show—Freddie’s last filmed Queen concert—opens in theaters and IMAX next Wednesday. Park Road Post restored the 35 mm; the band remixed the multitracks. Six days out for the Magic Tour in a dark room.

ON THE TOWN



Motorama – Thu Oct 1, 9:00 p.m., Auditorio Nacional

Rostov post-punk marks twenty years with its biggest CDMX date—coldwave guitars through Sleep, and I Will Sing. About two hours; overlaps Discovery—leave by mid-evening if you go.

Amadeus Live – Sat Oct 3, 7:30 p.m., Auditorio Nacional

Oscar-winning Amadeus with live orchestra/choir (Minería pops)—about two hours. Same building as Motorama; handy after Sat’s 7:00 p.m. GDG Probabilidad if you want a later indoor plan.

PUZZLES



MINI CROSSWORD

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

ACROSS

1 Gemini 4's code name in this morning's TLDR

6 What you might still leave on during Discovery if Motorama wins the evening

7 Quality bar Mattis says agents haven't dropped for him

8 Classic theater nickname; keep it in mind for Bellas Artes / Auditorio nights

9 What Cockroach and Colossus talks keep coming back to in distributed systems

DOWN

1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)

2 Same as 6-Across

3 Same as 7-Across

4 Same as 8-Across

5 Same as 9-Across

ARGON · RADIO · GRADE · ODEON · NODES

DEAR TIMES

Friday GDG, Saturday GDG, and two October tickets—what goes on the calendar first?

Dear Times, Friday is Maps + AI at 7:00 p.m., Saturday is Probabilidad at 7:00 p.m., and neither is on Google Calendar. La Casa on October 6 and the Buildathon on October 9 are already approved in Luma. Do I block the two GDG nights first, or drag the ticketed October events before something else fills the week?

— Double-booked in Mexico City

Dear Double-booked, Put the two GDG evenings on the calendar today so Friday and Saturday stop living only in mail. Then add La Casa (Oct 6) and the Buildathon (Oct 9) in the same pass—those already have tickets. Leave Checkpoint on Wednesday alone; it is already on the calendar. Overnight GitHub permission notices can wait for a short morning gap; they are not a third evening block.

— The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus. What you should do to overnight GitHub OAuth and Claude permission notices (4 letters).

EGAT

□○□□

WHOS

○□□□

NARI

□□□○

OECD

○□□□

GATE SHOW RAIN CODE · SCAN

WANTED

Two calendar blocks labeled Fri 7 p.m. and Sat 7 p.m.

Applicants must arrive already holding the GDG Maps + AI and Probabilidad reminders. Mail-only RSVPs will be turned away at the door of the week view.

Calendar entries for two already-approved October events.

La Casa de Satoshi (Oct 6) and the Agentic Buildathon (Oct 9) have tickets in mail. Citizens who cleared Luma are advised to drag both on before the weekend GDG pair is the only future item in view.

FOR SALE

Slightly used “verify tomorrow” stack.

Includes Wednesday’s audiogram-inbox Codex threads and a badge that has not turned green overnight. Buyer accepts that silence is not a pass.

Spare always-on Dot envy (conceptual).

Inspired by Every’s Altman interview and a triage bot named Dotty. Does not clear a Hetzner warning or a Modal OAuth notice. Transfers as FYI only.

NOTICES

Department of Cool Damp Mornings

About 15°C with light rain nearby at compile; high near 24°C; evening showers possible. Umbrellas useful if Discovery becomes Motorama. This is weather, not an RSVP.

Municipal GitHub desk

Overnight – Modal OAuth added; Claude app requesting updated permissions. Please confirm before Miami. Do not confuse with audiogram verify (still not green) or Friday’s Maps codelab.